Battalion HQ was relocated to Panamik while DBO was transformed into a base with a garrison of militiamen. By 1962, a dirt runway had been created at DBO, which was capable of taking C-114 Fairchild Packet aircraft. To take off from the strip, the aircraft were fitted with jet packs, which allowed them to handle the extremely rarefied atmosphere at those altitudes.

By the summer of 1962, it was obvious to both Generals Daulet Singh and Bikram Singh that the Chinese meant business. For the past few months, ever since the Forward Policy had been put into place, Kaul (now CGS), had been pushing Western Command to set up new posts. Most of these locations seemed to be picked by Kaul and the Intelligence chief, B. N. Mullik. Both Daulet Singh and Bikram Singh were frequent visitors to Delhi and often discussed logistical difficulties with the CGS. However, perhaps mindful of what had happened to Verma, neither of them was quite willing to openly oppose Kaul. In 1960, XV Corps had earmarked five battalions for the defence of Leh—three infantry and two militia. Two years down the line, the total force levels in Ladakh were still short of this minimum target.

The Chinese were slowly and steadily upping the ante; by April they had intruded into the Pangong-Spanggur, Hot Spring, Qara Qash and DBO sectors where they had established military strong points. The Chinese were now well beyond the line they had claimed in 1959. Still believing that the Chinese were playing mind games and an armed conflict was unlikely, Army HQ decided to airlift 5 Jat, commanded by Lieutenant Colonel Bakhtawar Singh, into Ladakh. Moving from Uri to Srinagar, Alpha Company arrived in Leh on 21 May while Bravo Company, the last to reach, finally landed at the Leh airfield at the end of August 1962. In between, Charlie Company under the command of Major Bhairon Singh, was flown to DBO in Fairchild Packets, arriving there on 23 July, two days after there had been a skirmish between the Indian militia and the Chinese.

The Jats were allowed just three days to acclimatize at DBO, which was at a height of 16,000 feet. They then took over the outposts, situated at even greater heights, from 14 J&K Militia in the Lungnak Lungspa Valley. By the end of July, the total concentration of Indian troops in the Northern Sector consisted of Charlie Company of 5 Jat with one section of 3-inch mortars, nine platoons of Militia, one platoon of Mahar troops with MMGs and a medical detachment. The area of responsibility for the Militia extended up to the rear depots at the Shyok-Galwan river junction.